■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, August 07, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (4 stories)

■ *'Grown Ups 3' Cast Revealed: Adam Sandler, Chris Rock and More - Variety*

The Angle: *'Grown Ups 3' Cast Revealed: Adam Sandler, Chris Rock and More - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/grown-ups-3-cast-adam-sandler-chris-rock-1236829352/

■■ *56 bodies found rotting at Chicago funeral home*

The Angle: *A couple running a Chicago funeral home has been caught storing 56 decomposing remains in unsanitary conditions—and this isn't their first rodeo. They previously ran a crematory shut down for the same kind of mishandling, raising serious questions about how this operation stayed open.*

- **56 remains** were discovered improperly stored and decomposing at a Chicago funeral home on Thursday
- The funeral home is run by a **couple who previously operated a crematory** that was also shut down for mishandled remains
- Authorities found the bodies in conditions that violated basic storage and handling standards

The Accountability Question

- How does a funeral home with a documented history of botching body handling get to open again and make the same mistakes?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/remains-improperly-stored-chicago-9.7300409?cmp=rss

■ *German airport averts disaster when explosive drone is stopped*

The Angle: *A bus driver at a major German airport made a split-second call to intercept a drone carrying explosives this week—and it didn't go off. Now Chancellor **Friedrich Merz** and lawmakers are calling the move heroic, even as federal prosecutors open a full counterterrorism investigation into how it got there in the first place.*

- **Chancellor Friedrich Merz** held an emergency call Friday to discuss the incident
- The drone was **laden with explosives** and crashed at **Leipzig/Halle Airport** earlier in the week
- The explosive device **did not detonate** after impact
- **Federal prosecutors** have launched a **counterterrorism probe** into the incident

The Gut Call

- Would you have done the same thing in the bus driver's shoes—or is that a risk nobody should take, even to stop a threat?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/german-leipzig-halle-airport-drone-incident-9.7299265?cmp=rss

■ *Surveillance footage shows civilians fighting back against Idaho shooter*

The Angle: *New video released from the In-N-Out shooting in Idaho reveals three brave bystanders who armed themselves and fired back at the gunman, potentially stopping him from killing more people. It's a rare and intense look at civilians taking direct action during an active shooter situation.*

- **Three civilians** fired back at **Idaho In-N-Out gunman Chad Williams** during the rampage
- Surveillance footage captured the heroic intervention live
- The civilian response is credited with helping to **stop the shooter from carrying out more carnage**

The Moral Line

- When danger hits, do civilians have a right—or a duty—to fight back? Where's the line between heroism and risk?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/us-news/surveillance-video-shows-heroes-firing-back-at-idaho-in-n-out-shooter-chad-williams/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Gareth Edwards Exits 'Jurassic World Rebirth' Sequel Over Creative Differences - Variety*

The Angle: *Gareth Edwards Exits 'Jurassic World Rebirth' Sequel Over Creative Differences - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/gareth-edwards-exits-jurassic-world-rebirth-sequel-creative-differences-1236829388/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Aaron Donald comeback: Can the legend still play at elite level?*

The Angle: *Aaron Donald's potential return to the Rams is sparking a real debate about whether the future Hall of Famer can still dominate at defensive tackle after time away—and his former teammate just weighed in with some hard truth.*

- **Aaron Donald** is being courted for a potential reunion with the **Los Angeles Rams**
- **Michael Brockers**, Donald's former teammate, recently gave a candid take on Donald's ability to return to **elite performance level**
- The speculation around Donald's health and readiness has generated significant momentum in the NFL community over the past week

The Comeback Question

- If you're a Rams fan or just a football head—do you think a player of Donald's caliber can actually recapture that magic, or is this nostalgia talking?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/sports/michael-brockers-says-aaron-donald-will-want-to-be-100-before-making-decision/

Backup options:

■ *RFK Jr. Roasted for Being Out of Touch on Grocery Prices*

The Angle: *The newly confirmed Health Secretary made a comment about food costs that's got people talking—and not in a good way. It's the latest example of a high-ranking official seeming disconnected from what everyday Americans actually pay at the supermarket.*

- **RFK Jr.** is a millionaire who now serves as **Health Secretary**
- He made remarks about grocery prices that critics say reveal how disconnected he is from typical household economics
- The comment has sparked backlash on social media and among observers questioning whether he understands real-world cost-of-living pressures

The Out-of-Touch Test

- Have you ever said something about money or shopping that made someone call you out for not living in reality—and were they right?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: The Grocery Reality Check** - Quick opener (1-2 min) -> Hosts share what they actually spent on a typical grocery run this week—specific items and real prices—to establish baseline reality before diving into why RFK Jr.'s comment landed so badly.
- **Step 2: The Wealth Disconnect** - Main segment (3-4 min) -> Unpack the broader pattern of wealthy public figures making tone-deaf comments about everyday costs. Ask: Does it matter if your Health Secretary understands what milk and eggs cost? Why do these moments go viral?
- **Step 3: Phone Line: Your Caught-You Moment** - Listener call-in (4-5 min) -> Invite callers to share a time they were called out for being out of touch with money/reality, or to weigh in on whether high-net-worth officials can still make good policy decisions.

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/rfk-jr-is-too-rich-to-know-the-price-of-groceries-not-rich-enough-to-stop-grifting-2000795929

■ *Flesh-eating bacteria claims five lives in Louisiana waters this year*

The Angle: *A deadly bacteria lurking in warm coastal waters is killing people faster than expected—and with summer heat ramping up, public health officials are sounding the alarm. This is the kind of real-world health threat that affects beach season for millions.*

- **Five deaths** confirmed so far in **Louisiana** in 2024 from flesh-eating bacteria found in warm coastal waters
- At least **nine cases** reported overall (suggesting more survivors with serious infections)
- The bacteria thrives in **warm coastal water**, making summer months the peak danger season

The Health Alert
- If you're heading to the beach or gulf coast this summer, what's one simple precaution you'd actually take after hearing this?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: The Risk Reality Check** - First 90 seconds -> Hosts walk through the actual odds—how common is this really? How do you catch it? This separates real threat from fear-mongering.
- **Step 2: Summer Plans Shift?** - Next 2-3 minutes -> Open phones: Are listeners changing beach plans, pool habits, or water activities based on health scares like this? Or do you just accept the risk?

CBS News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 53/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 6 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.cbsnews.com/news/vibrio-vulnificus-flesh-eating-bacteria-5-dead-louisiana-2026/

CLOSER: WHAT THE FRIDAY

■ *White Sox pulled starter after bizarre first-inning mistake*

The Angle: *A starting pitcher for the White Sox got yanked before things even got rolling—not because he was pitching badly, but because someone on the team screwed up in a way that forced the manager's hand. It's the kind of weird sports moment that's funny and baffling at the same time.*

- **Noah Schultz** was pulled from his start in the **first inning** on Friday
- The early exit had **nothing to do with his actual pitching performance**
- The removal was forced by a **bizarre mistake** made by the White Sox organization

The Curiosity Hook
- We don't have the full details yet—but what kind of mistake gets you benched before you even throw a full inning?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 69/90 (40 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/sports/white-sox-forced-to-remove-noah-schultz-in-first-inning-in-bizarre-scene/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ *Senate votes to hold Fauci in contempt over COVID stonewalling*

The Angle: *Republicans are escalating pressure on Dr. Fauci after he refused to answer over 100 questions about his pandemic role—invoking the Fifth Amendment repeatedly. It's shaping up as a major legal and political showdown about accountability, executive power, and what happens when a public health official goes silent.*

- **Senate committee voted to hold Dr. Anthony Fauci in contempt** after he invoked the **Fifth Amendment more than 100 times** during questioning
- The Fifth Amendment right protects against self-incrimination, but the committee argues **refusal to answer on those grounds raises legal questions** about whether it applies here
- Fauci was called to testify about his **role in the COVID-19 response** as former chief medical adviser to the president

The Accountability Question

- Should a top government health official be able to stay completely silent about decisions that affected millions of people during a pandemic—or is that a dodge?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - First 30 seconds -> Host A: Explain the contempt vote and the Fifth Amendment invocation in plain language—no legal jargon.
- **Step 2: The Tension** - Next 60 seconds -> Host B raises the core conflict: Does the Fifth Amendment actually apply to policy questions, or is Fauci using it as a shield? What's he protecting himself from?
- **Step 3: The Open Question** - Final 60 seconds -> Throw to audience: Do you think a public official has the right to stay silent on pandemic decisions that affected your life—or is that a red line? Invite calls or social.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7300238?cmp=rss

■ *Bezos and DiCaprio's $200M nature project under fire*

The Angle: *A high-profile environmental initiative backed by two of the world's most famous names is being accused of greenwashing—raising questions about whether big celebrity money actually moves the needle on species conservation, or just makes billionaires look good.*

- The **Phoenix Species Project** is backed by **Jeff Bezos** and **Leonardo DiCaprio**
- The project has **$200 million** in funding
- It faces accusations of **greenwashing** despite grassroots organizations using it to create real conservation impact

The Skeptic's Question

- Is celebrity-backed conservation just feel-good PR, or can a billionaire's billions actually save species?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/science/bezos-species-conservation-greenwashing-9.7298957?cmp=rss

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■ *Wildfires push climate back to top of Canadian minds*

The Angle: *After years of slipping down the priority list, climate change just jumped back to the front of Canadians' concerns—and wildfire season is the wake-up call. This is a real shift in what's keeping people up at night.*

- **Polling data shows a spike** in Canadians viewing climate change as a top priority this summer
- The surge follows **years of the issue taking a back seat** to other concerns like inflation, healthcare, and cost of living
- **Wildfire season** appears to be the driving factor behind the renewed urgency

The Reality Check

- Does it take smoke in your backyard for climate to actually feel real—or are we finally hitting a tipping point where Canadians can't ignore it anymore?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/climate-change-polling-wildfires-pipeline-9.7298966?cmp=rss

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■ *Letters to the Editor, Aug. 8, 2026*

The Angle: *Letters to the Editor, Aug. 8, 2026*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/opinion/letters/letters-to-the-editor-aug-8-2026

■ *Blue Jays' injury-prone reliever Yimi Garcia likely done for the season as he mulls surgery*

The Angle: *Blue Jays' injury-prone reliever Yimi Garcia likely done for the season as he mulls surgery*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/baseball/toronto-blue-jays/blue-jays-injury-prone-reliever-yimi-garcia-likely-done-for-the-season-as-he-mulls-surgery

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■ *SNOBELEN: Mark Carney following mistakes with tough-guy promises*

The Angle: *SNOBELEN: Mark Carney following mistakes with tough-guy promises*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/opinion/columnists/mark-carney-mistakes-tough-guy-promises

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■ *Brewers minor leaguer makes catch of the year bid with unbelievable home run robbery*

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nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/sports/brewers-minor-leaguer-makes-catch-of-the-year-with-homer-robbery/

■ *How UCLA's Nico Iamaleava plans to absorb fewer hits while protecting body*

The Angle: *How UCLA's Nico Iamaleava plans to absorb fewer hits while protecting body*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/sports/how-uclas-nico-iamaleava-plans-to-absorb-fewer-hits-while-protecting-body/

■ *Marcus Semien's homer powers Mets past Pirates to match season high with fourth straight win*

The Angle: *Marcus Semien's homer powers Mets past Pirates to match season high with fourth straight win*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/sports/mets-defeat-pirates-for-season-best-fourth-straight-win/

■ *Hunter Greene undergoing season-ending elbow surgery in another crushing injury setback*

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nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/07/sports/reds-hunter-greene-undergoing-season-ending-elbow-surgery/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 21 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: 'Your love will forever be woven into who we are'" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)
- "'Scrubs' Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "The Beauty Finds I'm Buying During Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "'La La Land' 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling's Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)
- "'Harry Potter' Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature 'Sorcerer's Stone' 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC's 'Happy's Place'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)

- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn’t Invited to Partake in ‘Wizards of Waverly Place’ Revival: “Disappointed”" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn’t Invited to Partake in ‘Wizards of Waverly Place’ Revival: “Disappointed”"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- Morning Brew (fetch failed, or no issue in the inbox yet)
- 15 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-08 02:27 AM